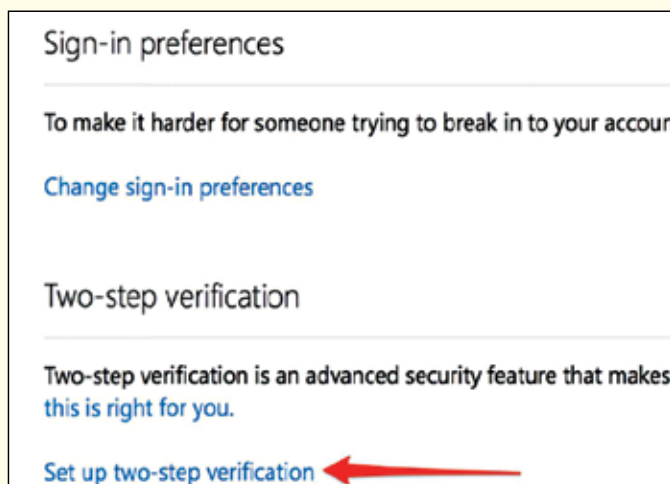




to your account for which you wish to activate two-factor authentication. Go to Privacy and Security, and click on Get Started link under 2-step verification. You will go through a set of security questions. In the next step you will be asked to enter your phone number, then a verification code will be sent to your phone. Before this you need to activate the Find my iPhone service for all your devices. After that a recovery key will be

other information to optimise and provide their services efficiently. Applications such as Facebook received a lot of slack from its users when it asked access to their contacts, phone number, calendar and locations. The sharing of sensitive data to apps may compromise the user's privacy. So, by disabling access to data inside apps, users can reduce the chances of losing data to unknown sources. Here are tips on how



Keep your phone near you during this process

given to you. After confirming, you will be able to enable two-factor authentication.

Windows

Login into your Microsoft account and head over to the Security settings page. Under two-step verification, choose Set two-step verification to turn it on and select your device's platform. MS allows authentication from all platforms. Enter the security code sent to your phone. Your 2-step verification is now activated, you will be given a recovery key in case you aren't carrying your mobile device with you.

Revoke app access permissions

Across various platforms, apps dig into your mobile phones to collect data and

to revoke the access to apps across platforms.

Android

The latest Android update now lets you grant permission to apps individually. It also introduced runtime permissions allowing users to select whether they



Select the category you want to revoke access



Select categories that you want to revoke access

want to give an app access to certain permissions such as location, mic etc. This gives the users greater control to share sensitive data with the app. To select what information you want to allow the apps to access, go to Settings > Apps and tap on the three dots and then select Configure Apps > Apps Permission. You will see a list of all the types of access the app requires and you will be able to toggle them on or off as desired.

iOS

Apple has always taken app permissions seriously. iOS also supports runtime permission to allow apps to access private data. However, you can select individual apps and their individual functions that can access the data and features. To do this go to Settings > Privacy, select the category that you want to modify permissions. Then you can grant or deny access to functions by simply toggling the app name and changing its behaviour individually.

Windows

To allow or deny individual apps to access device information on Windows go to Start > Settings > Privacy, which will present you with a list of all the app permissions. Tapping into these categories will give you the option to globally allow or deny the permissions system-wide. Or you can scroll down to individually set permissions for the apps installed on your phone.

Disable background data collection

Background data is collected across platforms to provide better experience to users by collecting useful data. However, this exploits the privacy of the user. This information may be compromised if not collected in secure manner. Collecting data without the knowledge of the user itself is unethical. But again, disabling permissions to apps doesn't guarantee that your data is not being collected by the OEMs.

Android

There's a lot of bloatware in Android that may collect data from the device. Google may collect telemetry data of your phone like device status, MAC address etc. Ad companies require location information and personal data to track the user's needs. Ad blockers can be used to avoid browsers from collecting data from the user's inputs and sharing it with the ad company. Usually malicious attacks happen through such infected ads. So, installing an ad blocking app may help in preventing background data collection and compromise.

iOS

Data may be collected from Spotlight Search in iOS. Apple keyboard also remembers words and handwriting of users and are stored at Apple's servers. The dictation feature of iOS lets the user convert speech to